

Shawn Crahen

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SUMMARY

Senior Software Developer and Scrum Master with four years of professional full-stack experience designing, building, and evolving scalable Java/Spring platforms supporting websites with 150,000+ monthly visitors. Combines 20 years of Coast Guard leadership with strong business judgment to lead complex initiatives, mentor engineers across experience levels, and rapidly develop expertise in new technologies.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Developer, Penbay Technology Group

March 2023 to Present

- Architected and evolved scalable web applications serving 150,000+ users using Java, Spring, Hibernate, REST APIs, and PostgreSQL/Oracle, with a focus on performance, extensibility, and long-term maintainability.
- Led consolidation of 20+ publication templates into a unified metadata-driven architecture, demonstrating systems-level thinking and reducing QA effort by 30%.
- Modernized legacy frontend architecture by replacing AngularJS with Spring, Thymeleaf, and JavaScript, reducing security risk and improving long-term maintainability.
- Built internal tooling (including an in-browser spreadsheet editor) requiring cross-layer design, state management, and thoughtful UX tradeoffs.
- Acted as Scrum Master and mentor for an 18-person team, coaching engineers across experience levels and frequently leading peers with deeper tenure in specific technologies.
- Improved sprint throughput and predictability by 20% through pragmatic Agile process improvements grounded in delivery data and team feedback.
- Championed code quality and testing discipline using JUnit and Mockito, achieving 100% coverage on critical paths and reducing defects by 15%.

Software Developer, Penbay Technology Group

April 2022 to March 2023

- Built and extended full-stack web applications using Java, Spring, REST APIs, and JavaScript, rapidly ramping into unfamiliar domains to meet project demands.
- Designed and implemented a role-based permissions system, reducing QA effort by 20% and improving operational safety.
- Mentored junior developers and resolved 150+ Jira issues, often serving as a go-to resource despite relatively short tenure.

Master Chief Petty Officer (E-9), United States Coast Guard

April 2002 to July 2022

- Led and mentored high-performing teams in complex, high-stakes operational environments, developing leadership skills directly transferable to large-scale software systems and organizations.
- Regularly led teams with greater technical or domain experience, relying on systems thinking, decision-making under uncertainty, and accountability rather than positional authority.
- Shaped national policy and training programs, increasing workforce qualification rates by 40%, experience now applied to mentoring engineers and improving team capability.

SKILLS

Languages: Java, JavaScript, SQL (PostgreSQL, Oracle), HTML, CSS, SASS

Frameworks & Tooling: Spring, Hibernate, REST APIs, Git, JUnit, Mockito, React

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Docker

Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, TDD

CLOUD & MODERN ENGINEERING DEVELOPMENT (SELF-DIRECTED)

- Actively building hands-on expertise in AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, and modern frontend frameworks to prepare for cloud-native and microservices-oriented systems.
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect and Developer Associate; continuously studying distributed systems, scalability, and operational design patterns.
- Known for rapidly tooling up in new stacks and becoming productive quickly, including mentoring others once proficiency is established.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate, March 2024

AWS Certified Developer - Associate, February 2024

Spring Certified Professional, November 2023

Professional Scrum Master II, June 2023

Certified ScrumMaster, February 2023

EDUCATION

M.S. Computer Science, *University of Illinois, Springfield*

B.S. Environmental Science, *American Military University*